Franziska Strunz

Doctoral Candidate & Research Assistant | Macroeconomics | University of the Bundeswehr Munich
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EDUCATION

Doctoral Studies in Macroeconomics *2021 – 2027*
University of the Bundeswehr Munich (Germany); Teaching and Research Assistant *(expected)*
Thesis topic: "Essays in Business Cycle Research"; Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Johannes Pfeifer

M.Sc. in Economics & M.Sc. Economics and Financial Economics *2018 – 2020*
(Dual Degree)
University of Tübingen (Germany) & University of Nottingham (UK)
Thesis: "International Spillover Effects of Fiscal Policy and the Global Financial Cycle"*;*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller

B.Sc. Economics & B.A. International Economics and Development *2014 - 2018*
University of Bayreuth (Germany)
Exchange Semester at Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso (Chile)

RESEARCH

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Forecasting & Expectations Formation; Fiscal Policy; Business Cycle Fluctuations; Empirical Macro; Time-Series Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

Does Reputation Matter? An Evaluation of Professional Forecasts for Germany (Job Market Paper)
joint work with Maximilian Gödl

Abstract: This paper evaluates the performance of identified (non-anonymous) professional forecasters and examines whether public reputation affects bias, efficiency, and expectation formation. We study non-anonymous forecasts of real GDP growth and CPI inflation from 1969 to 2024, published by well-known German economic research institutes, and compare them with anonymous forecasts from the US Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF). Reputation does not affect the overall accuracy of forecasts, but improves forecast efficiency in the case of German inflation forecasts. For both datasets, we find that growth and inflation forecasts are unbiased at forecast horizons up to one year. While we find a similar degree of informational efficiency in German growth forecasts as in the SPF, we cannot reject the hypothesis of full-information rational expectations (FIRE) for German inflation forecasts. The accuracy and efficiency of growth forecasts depend strongly on the state of the business cycle, suggesting that forecasters allocate more attention to predicting growth during recessions.

Replication of Auerbach and Gorodnichenko (2016): Effects of Fiscal Shocks in a Globalized World
preparation for a webinar series: Replicating empirical studies in economics - an opportunity for students

Abstract: I show that the replication files of Auerbach and Gorodnichenko (2016) do not generate the exact results of the paper. While the main effect of government spending shocks on the exchange rate, an appreciation, is preserved, it is quantitatively smaller and lacks statistical significance. I discuss potential reasons for this finding. I also extend the sample period and show that the higher power is insufficient to restore significance. This paper aims to take the learnings from this replication and add to the discussion of reproducibility and replicability in economics and the common problems that arise in this process.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Debt and Long-Term Interest Rates: Evidence from Germany**
- **Tariffs as Fiscal Policy** *(joint work with Johannes Pfeifer and Maximilian Gödl)*

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

European Economic Association Annual Meeting Dublin (presentation); Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference Innsbruck (presentation); 5th Bavarian Macro Day	*2026*
Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference Cologne (presentation); PhD seminar UniBw Munich (presentation); 4th Bavarian Macro Day	*2025*
IWH Halle Workshop on Forecasting in Times of Structural Change and Uncertainty (poster); ACM REP (poster); META-REP 2024 (presentation); 14th ifo Conference on Macroeconomics and Survey Data; 3rd Bavarian Macro Day	*2024*
2nd Bavarian Macro Day (presentation); Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference Regensburg (presentation); PhD seminar UniBw Munich (presentation)	*2023*
Social science webinar series on reproducibility and replication (presentation); PhD seminar UniBw Munich (presentation)	*2022*
Bavarian Graduate Program in Economics (BGPE) course in Advanced Econometrics (with Jeffrey M. Wooldridge)	*2021*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Federal Ministry of Finance, Berlin (Germany) — *2023 – 2024*
Doctorate Program, part-time position

Institute for Applied Economic Research, Tübingen (Germany) — *2020- 2021*
Student Assistant

Union Bank and Trust, Lincoln, Nebraska (USA) — *2019*
10-week Internship; Trust Department (Union Investment Management Group)

German Federal Foreign Office, Berlin (Germany) — *2017*
Internship

TEACHING

Principles of Macroeconomics (German title: Grundzüge der Makroökonomik), *tutorial class*	*2021 – 2026*
Econometrics (German title: Empirische Wirtschaftsforschung), *tutorial class*	*2021 - 2026*
Business Cycles and Growth (German title: Konjunktur und Wachstum), *tutorial class*	*2021 - 2024*
Macroeconomic Challenges in A Globalized Economy (German title: Makroökonomische Herausforderungen in einer globalisierten Wirtschaft), *tutorial class*	*2021 – 2023*
Foundations of Monetary and Exchange Rate Policy (German title: Grundlagen der Geld- und Währungspolitik), *tutorial class*	*2021 - 2022*

OTHER

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

- Very good knowledge of Stata, MATLAB, R; experience with Dynare
- Proficient in LaTeX, MS PowerPoint/ MS Excel/ MS Word

DATA

- Time-Series and Macro Data (large panels): estimation based on VARs and local projections
- Forecasts (especially fixed-event forecasts): focus on forecast evaluation; panel estimation methods
- Survey data (SOEP), Bloomberg, Firms and Bank Balance Sheet data

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), French (basic knowledge), Latin

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Scholarship by the Hanns-Seidel Foundation (undergraduate and graduate studies) *2015 – 2020*

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Johannes Pfeifer
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Dr. Marius Clemens
German Federal Ministry of Finance
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